

Andrea Neyra-Nazarrett

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Education

Harvard University Cambridge, MA 2021–2027 (expected)
Ph.D. in Political Economy and Government, Economics track.

Harvard Kennedy School of Government Cambridge, MA 2021
Master in Public Policy. Fulbright–García Robles Scholar.

Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México (ITAM) Mexico City 2018
B.A. in Economics. Graduated with the Highest Honors.

Fields

Organizational Economics, Personnel Economics; Labor Economics; Development Economics.

References

Jesse Shapiro (Chair)
jesse.m.shapiro@gmail.com

Emily Breza
ebreza@fas.harvard.edu

Jorge Tamayo
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Job Market Paper

Discipline at Work: Wage Premia, Managers, and Shirking in a Large Mexican Retailer
(Solo-authored)

Inventory shrinkage—merchandise missing from the store—accounts for about 1.6 percent of sales for United States retailers, on the order of grocers' net profit margin. Yet its drivers are not well understood. I study how wage premia and managerial monitoring jointly deter shrinkage when monitoring is imperfect, using administrative records from a large Mexican retailer with more than 300 stores and roughly 25,000 workers at a time. Leveraging manager rotations that are not directed by store performance, I estimate each manager's effect on shrinkage. The managers who reduce it are not better bookkeepers; they monitor: they work more shifts, including nights and weekends, are more co-present with their workers on the floor, and rework the teams they inherit. On demographic characteristics they are indistinguishable from the rest. Shrinkage also falls with the wage premium. The two reinforce each other: the same arrival reduces shrinkage about three times as much where the premium is high, a difference of 8 percentage points. A model in which the premium and monitoring are complements can match these facts: where the premium gives the manager's dismissal threat something to confiscate, the same manager accomplishes more.

[[Latest draft available here](#)]

Working Papers

Training Within Firms NBER Working Paper No. 33670, 2025
with Brayan Diaz, Julian Ramirez, Raffaella Sadun & Jorge Tamayo.

We study the organizational frictions that hinder training implementation within firms, focusing on middle

managers. Using data from three large Latin American firms (a car manufacturer, a quick-service restaurant chain, and a retailer), we show that managers who promote employee development raise training take-up and performance; event-study estimates around managerial rotations show “High Training” managers increase participation by up to 60%.

Back Office Matters: Managerial Quality in Retail

with Achyuta Adhvaryu, Parker Howell, Anant Nyshadham & Jorge Tamayo.

How does a manager’s ability to manage attention—their own and their subordinates’—affect productivity? Using administrative data from a large South American retail firm and a policy that rotates middle managers across stores, we show that managers who raise sales do so through three strategies: reducing stockouts, shrinking inventory (value and inventory-to-sales ratio), and improving pricing. High performers also reallocate personnel toward back-of-store roles.

VAT Holidays as Short-Term Economic Stimuli: Evidence from Colombia’s “Días sin IVA”

IDB Working Paper, 2024

with José Martínez-Carrasco, David Muñoz-Sánchez, Alejandro Rasteletti & Diego Zamora.

Using high-frequency transaction data and a repeated regression-discontinuity design across eight VAT holidays (2020–2022), we find that the policy raised sales in formal businesses by 15% net of intertemporal substitution, with substantial cross-sector spillovers—highlighting the stimulus potential of broad-based tax holidays in developing economies.

Teaching Experience

Harvard College

Teaching Fellow, Economics of Discontinuous Change (Econ 1818)	2024–2025
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Harvard University – Division of Continuing Education

Teaching Fellow, Survey Research Methods	2022–2025
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Teaching Fellow, Advanced Research Methods for Social Science	2022–2025
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Harvard Kennedy School

Teaching Fellow, Advanced Quantitative Methods: Causal Inference (API-210)	2026
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Tutor, Quantitative Analysis and Empirical Methods (API-201)	2025
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Teaching Fellow, The Politics of Development (DPI-410)	2021
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Teaching Fellow, Public Finance in International Perspective (DEV-215)	2020
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Teaching Assistant, Advanced Markets and Market Failure (API-101Z)	2019
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Presentations

NBER Summer Institute, Personnel Economics (<i>Back Office Matters</i>)	2025
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NBER Summer Institute, Personnel Economics (<i>Training Within Firms</i>)	2024
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Labor Economics Lunch, Harvard University	2026
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Research Grants

Weatherhead Center for International Affairs, Dissertation Writing Grant, Harvard	2026–2027
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Kenneth C. Griffin Economics Research Fund, Harvard	2024
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Colombia–Santo Domingo Research Fund, Department of Economics, Harvard	2023
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DRCLAS Summer Research Travel Grant, Harvard	2023, 2026
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Ash Center for Democratic Governance & Innovation, Research Grant, Harvard	2020
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Harvard Kennedy School Summer Research Fellowship	2020
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Fellowships, Scholarships, and Honors

Dissertation Completion Fellowship, Harvard (Mildred Rendl PhD 1954 Fellowship)	2026–2027
Fulbright–García Robles Scholarship	2019–2021
Conacyt–FUNED Graduate Scholarship	2019
Comecyt Talent and Excellence Scholarship	2019
Dionisio Medina Harvard Scholarship	2019
Highest Honors, B.A. in Economics, ITAM	2018

Professional Activities

Co-Chair, The MX Conference, Harvard Kennedy School	2021
Co-Organizer, The MX Conference	2020

Previous Professional Experience

World Bank — Consultant, Macroeconomics & Growth (DEC)	Washington, DC	2020–2021
Inter-American Development Bank — Consultant, Fiscal & Municipal Mgmt.	Mexico City	2018–2019

Skills & Personal

Software: Proficient in Stata; working knowledge of Python and R.

Languages: Spanish (native), English (proficient), German (limited).

Interests: Marathon runner and open-water long-distance swimmer.